



Bringing up the kids

It's natural for parents to care for their offspring, but sometimes other members of the community pitch in to feed or babysit the young. In an extended family group there is often a dominant breeding pair and only they will have babies. By caring for their siblings, juveniles help keep the babies safe while the parents hunt, and also teach their younger brothers and sisters essential survival skills.

HOW COME I
ALWAYS END UP
BABYSITTING?

COMMUNITY OF
CHIMPANZEES

ON THE HUNT

Hunting in packs enables animals to catch prey that would be tricky to bring down alone. Attacks are carefully coordinated, each animal playing its part in stalking and cornering the victim. However, once the prey is caught, hierarchy takes over, with the pack leader getting the pick of the prime morsels from the carcass.

Caring and sharing

Being part of a group means that there is always someone to help get rid of those pesky parasites in difficult-to-reach places or to snuggle up to on chilly nights. But close proximity makes it easy for parasite numbers to soar out of control and disease can spread quickly. On the upside, many paws make light work when it comes to constructing homes.

AFRICAN
WILD DOGS

GANG OF MEERKATS

Pecking order

Not all animals in a group are equal. Most communities have a number of dominant animals at the top who get first pick of the available food, shelter, and mates. Those lower down the ranks have to make do with whatever they can beg, steal, or sneakily get away with. Keeping your position means forming alliances or being prepared to fight. Once an order is established the aggression stops.

Follow me,
ladies...

FLOCK
OF HENS